

Zayd Mahmud

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EDUCATION

Plano West Senior High School

Rank: 70/1,189 (Top 5.8%) · GPA: 4.61 (W) / 4.46 (UW)
SAT: 1570 (770RW / 790M) · ACT: 36 · PSAT: 1500 (SI 225)

Plano, Texas

Expected Grad: May 2027

EXPERIENCE

Independent Debate Coach & Consultant

Plano, Texas

Director of Debate, GEM Academy & Lead PF Consultant, Outreach Debate

Apr 2025 – Present

- Coached **50+** debaters to state qualifications, TOC bids, and the **2026 Texas PF Championship**.
- Authored and open-sourced **\$15K+** in resources to **500+** debaters globally, instructing **6 free camps** over **500+** hours.
- Managed GEM's seasonal program logistics, supervised 4 instructional peers, and coordinated thousands in cash flow.

Freelance 3D Artist (@zira3d)

Plano, Texas

3D Generalist

Jun 2022 – Present

- Ran a **5-figure** 3D production business from concept to delivery; reinvested profits into studio hardware.
- Garnered **1M+** impressions and acclaim from **Riot Games**, **Bungie**, and **Halo Studios**.

City of Richardson – Office of the Mayor

Richardson, Texas

Media Specialist

Apr 2026 – Present

- Directed media production, filming and editing short- and long-form content series to elevate mayoral brand image.
- Helped expand channel following to **7.7K followers**, reaching **150K+** Texans over four months.

Jason Pearce for Congress

Plano, Texas

Media Director

Apr 2026 – Present

- Co-founded multimedia team for TX CD-4 Democratic candidate; managed campaign outreach and scheduling.
- Sole director of video production, oversaw diverse media campaign reaching **250k+ voters** in the 2026 election cycle.

BASMAH Foundation

Plano, Texas

Motivational Speaker & Emcee

Jun 2025 – Jan 2026

- Keynoted galas raising **\$500K+** to deliver water, shelter, and schooling to **80,000+** Rohingya refugees.
- Coordinated program logistics, stage management, and live audience engagements for events with hundreds of donors.

Islamic Association of Collin County

Plano, Texas

Guest Speaker & Emcee

Sep 2021 – Present

- Programmed, emceed annual banquets addressing **300+** educators; advocated for interfaith unity at regional events.

Volunteer Teacher

Sep 2021 – May 2023

- Curated and taught K–8 curricula in Islamic ethics, history, and Arabic for **100+ students**.
- Managed parent reports, student discipline, and mentorship. Taught 30+ in sole special-needs Arabic program.

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

Speech and Debate – Plano West HS, Jasper HS, Rice MS

Plano, Texas

Team Captain & Lincoln-Douglas Debater

Sep 2021 – Present

- Ranked **top 25 nationally**; Harvard semifinalist (3rd/248, TOC Bid); **top 32 globally**, IPPF essay competition.
- Ranked **4th in Texas**, won **5 Texas titles**, only sophomore competitor to reach TFA State Sweet 16 in 2025.
- Mentored teams of **200+** debaters; organized practices, summer fundraiser camp raising **\$14K** with **120+** participants.

Boy Scouts of America – Troops 261 and 2060

Plano, Texas

Eagle Scout, Senior Patrol Leader, Camp Staff & Lifeguard

May 2020 – Sep 2025

- Earned **Eagle Scout** rank (top 2%); planned, led **\$1.4K** community center restoration supervising 10+ volunteers.
- Mentored 30+ scouts through **70+** advancements; served summer and winter camps as lifeguard, merit badge counselor.

Muslim Student Association – Plano West HS & Jasper HS

Plano, Texas

Co-President

Aug 2023 – May 2025

- Coordinated interfaith events and **daily prayers for hundreds** of high school students across DFW.
- Liaised with Plano ISD administration to protect student prayer rights and encourage MSA chapters district-wide.

HONORS & AWARDS

AP Scholar with Distinction: Earned by scoring 3+ on 5+ AP Exams with an average score of 3.5+.

National Honor Society: Inducted for academic excellence, leadership, community service, and character.

IACC Youth Excellence Award: Inaugural award recognizing outstanding Plano youth leadership, service, or achievement.

Bungie Artist of the Week: Selected out of 10K+ community art submissions for feature in weekly newsletter.

Halo Studios Community Spotlight: Selected out of 3K+ art submissions for monthly community accolade.